

Data Management Policy

Sample policy with intentional omissions and ambiguous control language for analyzer testing

Field	Value
Document Owner	Operations and Analytics
Version	1.0
Effective Date	2026-02-01
Review Cycle	Periodic
Classification	Internal

1. Purpose

This policy describes the organization's general expectations for creating, storing, sharing, and using data in support of business operations. The aim is to promote practical stewardship of information so that teams can work efficiently and make sound decisions.

Data is an important organizational asset. Personnel should handle data carefully and in a way that is consistent with business needs, customer expectations, and applicable obligations.

2. Scope

This policy applies to data maintained in company systems, shared drives, collaboration tools, reporting environments, and other repositories used to support business activity.

The policy covers both structured and unstructured information, including customer information, financial records, operational reports, project documents, and analytical datasets.

3. General Principles

Business units are responsible for the quality and usefulness of the data they create or maintain. Data should be kept reasonably accurate, organized, and available to those who need it for legitimate work purposes.

Teams should avoid collecting or retaining information that does not have a clear business purpose. Where duplicate records are identified, teams should take practical steps to reconcile them.

- Data should be stored in approved organizational systems where possible.
- Users should take care when copying data between systems.
- Important business records should be preserved appropriately.

4. Data Quality and Maintenance

System owners and data users should make reasonable efforts to keep data current and suitable for reporting, operational use, and decision-making. Known issues affecting completeness or consistency should be addressed in the normal course of work.

Where recurring data quality problems arise, the responsible team should review root causes and identify an appropriate response.

5. Data Sharing and Access

Access to data should align with job responsibilities and business need. Data may be shared internally to support operations, analysis, service delivery, and oversight activities.

External sharing should be handled with care and should involve the relevant business owner when the data is sensitive, customer-related, or commercially important.

6. Retention and Disposal

Data should be retained for a period that is appropriate to business and legal needs. When information is no longer needed, teams should dispose of it in a sensible manner using approved methods where available.

Business areas may maintain more specific retention schedules for specialized records.

7. Security and Confidentiality

Personnel must use good judgment when handling confidential or sensitive information. Sensitive data should not be disclosed to unauthorized parties and should be processed in company-approved environments.

The organization may apply technical protections and monitoring as appropriate for business needs.

8. Roles and Responsibilities

Business leaders, system owners, and data users all play a role in responsible data handling. Teams are expected to coordinate where decisions about definitions, access, or reporting logic affect more than one function.

Questions about unusual data handling scenarios should be escalated to the relevant manager or functional lead.

9. Exceptions and Compliance

Exceptions to this policy may be approved where business requirements justify an alternative approach. Employees are expected to comply with this policy and any related procedures.